

State Employment Relations Board



2020 Wage Settlement Report

For Labor Contracts that began January 1, 2020 – December 31, 2020



INTRODUCTION

The State Employment Relations Board (SERB) is pleased to present the 2020 Wage Settlement Report. This report is a detailed look at the across-the-board wage increase percentage and other monetary incentives that have been negotiated in public sector labor contracts (collective bargaining agreements) that took effect in calendar year 2020.

REVISION NOTES

There were minimal changes to the format and layout of this year's report compared to the previous year.

REPORT BACKGROUND & METHODS

In its 30th year, the purpose of this report is to inform stakeholders of the latest trends in negotiated wage increases in labor contracts for public sector entities. The goal is to provide statistics that may be useful for both the employer and employee organizations and to promote orderly and constructive labor relationships between public employers and their employees. This report includes data extracted from negotiated labor contracts from the following public sector jurisdictions:

Government	Schools	Colleges/Universities	Special Districts
• State • Counties • Cities • Townships	• School Districts (City, Local, Exempted Village) • Joint Vocational Schools & Career Centers • Educational Service Centers (ESCs)	• Community Colleges • State Colleges • State Universities	• Fire Districts • Metro Housing Authorities • Port Authorities • Regional Transit Authorities

REPORT SUMMARY

This year's report includes data extracted from 828 negotiated labor contracts with a start date between January 1, 2020 and December 31, 2020.

- There were 746 labor contracts that contained a wage increase percentage during the duration of the contract. The statewide average increase was 2.15% in year 1 (2020), 2.32% in year 2 (2021), and 2.35% in year 3 (2022). (Table 1)
- The statewide average wage increase percentage for the entire duration of the contract was 2.26%. This percentage is an average of all wage increase percentages that took effect during the duration of each contract, which includes year 1, 2, and 3 if available. This statewide average wage increase is .05% less than what was reported in last year's report (Table 2).
- There were 88 out of 828 contracts that had one or more lump sums that took effect during the duration of the contract. The statewide average lump sum was \$832 in year 1 (2020), \$708 in year 2 (2021), and \$940 in year 3 (2022). (Table 3). A lump sum is a one-time dollar amount which is not added to the base wage scale.
- There were 59 contracts that included a cents per hour increase that went into effect during the duration of the contract. The statewide average cents per hour increase was \$0.72 in year 1 (2020), \$0.57 in year 2 (2021), and \$0.50 in year 3 (2022). A further breakdown of these stats is not included in this report due to the low quantity reported.

AVERAGE NEGOTIATED WAGE INCREASE PERCENTAGE

Table 1 displays the average across-the-board wage increase percentage negotiated in labor contracts that went into effect in calendar year 2020. The wage increases were grouped by effective date and filtered by each comparison group below. Instances where there was no wage increase or monetary incentive issued during a calendar year were recorded as a zero percent wage increase.

A detailed breakdown of what is included in each comparison group can be found on page 9.

Table 1

Average Negotiated Wage Increase Percentage (%) By Calendar Year						
Comparison Group	2020		2021		2022	
	Avg	#	Avg	#	Avg	#
Statewide	2.15%	687	2.32%	570	2.35%	510
Region						
(1) Akron/Canton	2.24%	115	2.31%	115	2.30%	102
(2) Cincinnati	2.25%	80	2.59%	64	2.63%	53
(3) Cleveland	2.04%	124	2.11%	116	2.21%	106
(4) Columbus	2.36%	99	2.55%	82	2.64%	72
(5) Dayton	2.14%	88	2.61%	51	2.62%	45
(6) Southeast Ohio	2.28%	38	2.28%	32	2.56%	26
(7) Toledo	1.78%	85	2.37%	63	2.37%	57
(8) Warren/Youngstown	2.15%	58	1.86%	47	1.69%	49
Jurisdiction						
City	2.43%	234	2.49%	226	2.48%	204
County	2.11%	129	2.18%	112	2.29%	104
Township	2.68%	52	2.64%	57	2.43%	56
School District	1.71%	230	1.99%	134	2.12%	104
Other	2.42%	42	2.49%	41	2.38%	42
Unit Type						
Police (Safety/Security)	2.38%	229	2.49%	211	2.47%	200
Fire	2.66%	68	2.67%	71	2.53%	65
Teacher (BOE)	1.65%	148	1.95%	84	2.11%	65
Non-Teaching (BOE)	1.85%	94	2.07%	63	2.13%	51
Blue-Collar	2.22%	46	2.31%	46	2.28%	46
Other	2.26%	102	2.23%	95	2.30%	83
#: Number of Contracts (746 out of 828 filed contained a percent increase)						
Contracts Statewide with 0% Increase: 2020 = 98; 2021 = 30; 2022 = 27						

The following four charts are visual representations of data found in Table 1.

Chart 1 compares the average wage increase percentage for all contracts that began in calendar year 2020 by year 1, 2, and 3 of the contracts (if available). Please note that contract duration, wage reopeners, and other factors decrease the volume of contracts that are available when calculating the averages for year 2 and year 3 of the contract.

Chart 1

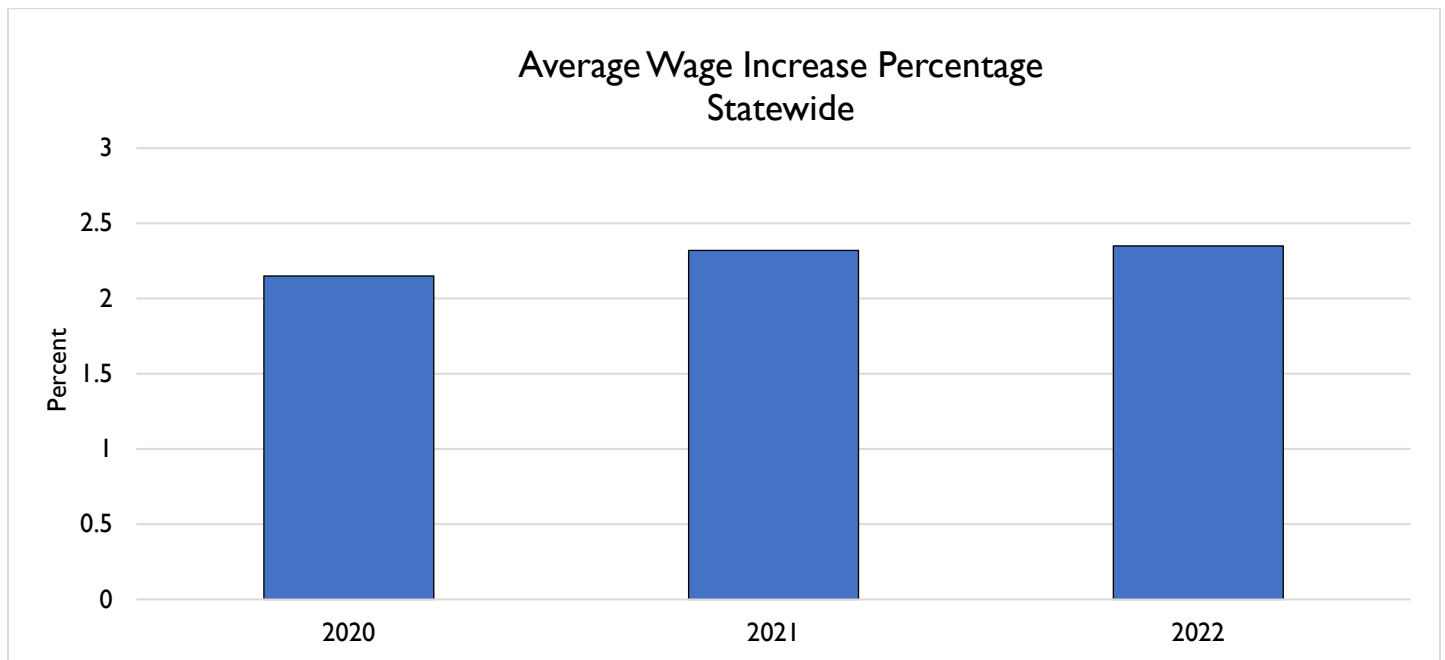


Chart 2 is a visual representation of the region section of the data found in Table 1. Each region consists of several geographically proximate counties. A list of the counties included in each region can be found on page 9.

Chart 2

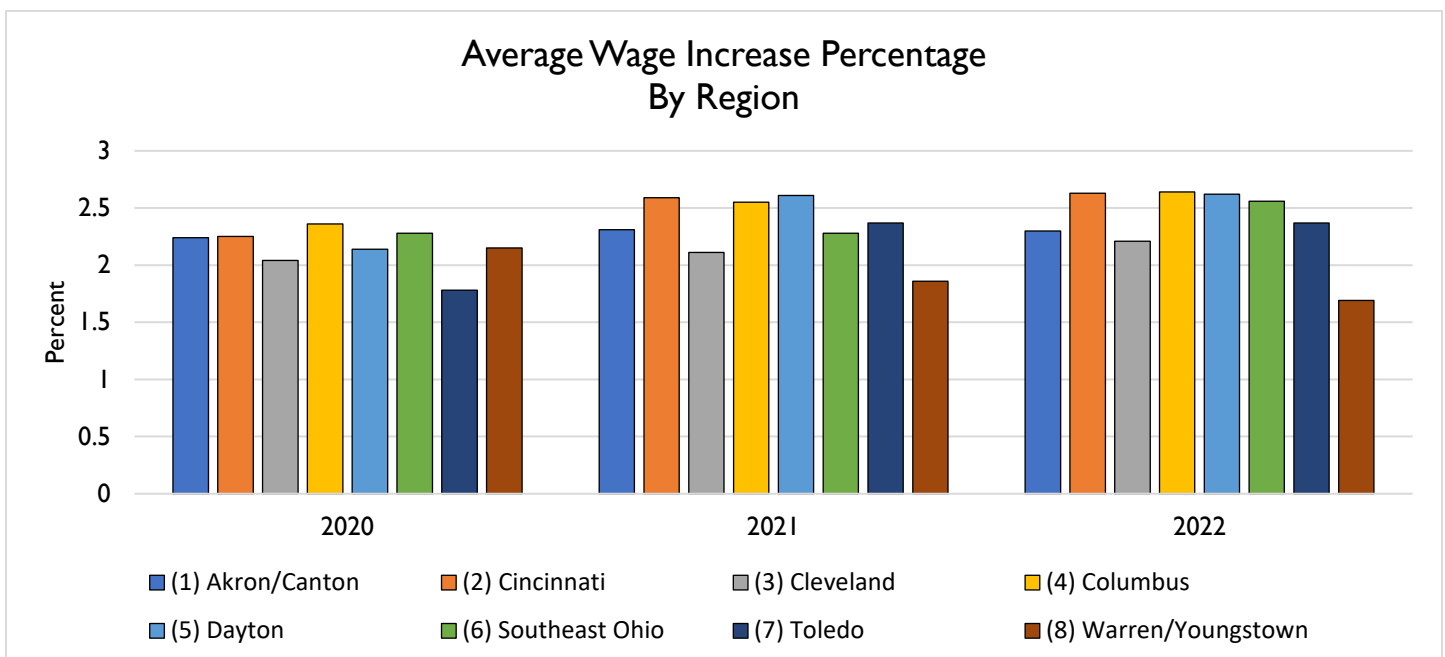


Chart 3 is a visual representation of the jurisdiction section of the data found in Table 1. A detailed list of the employer types included in each group can be found on page 9.

Chart 3

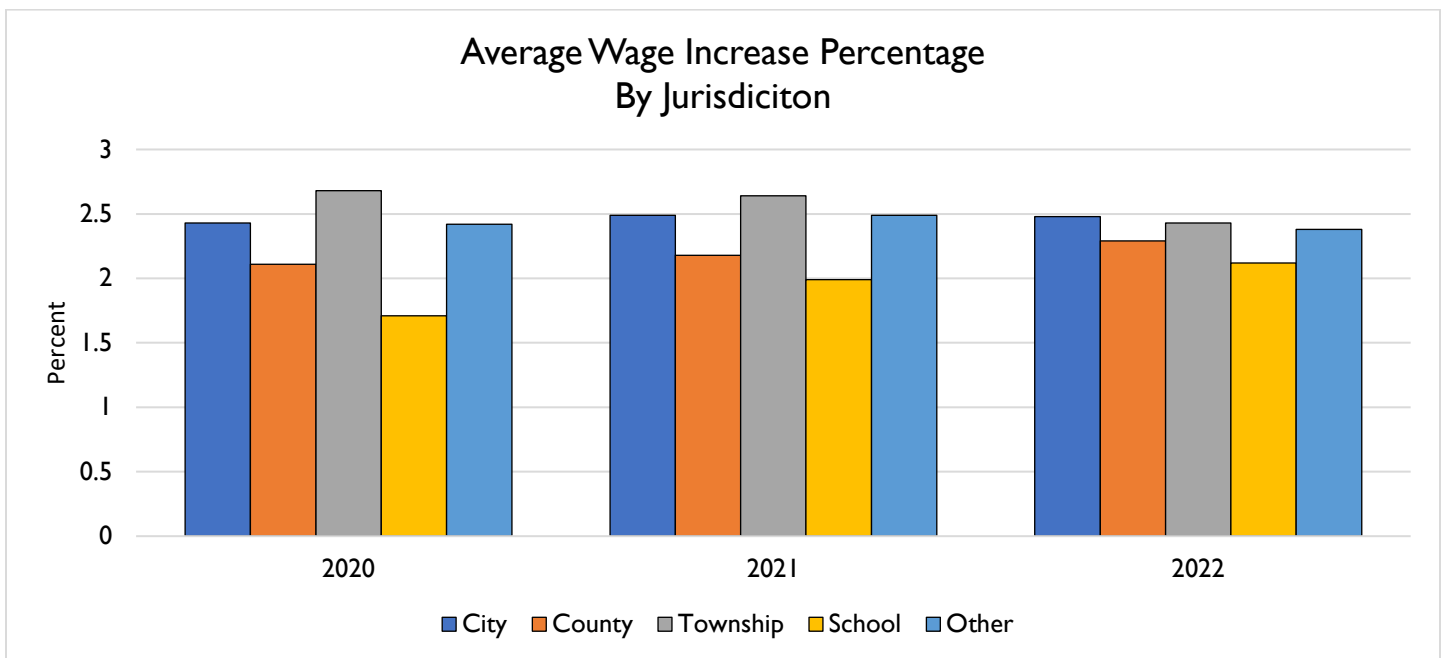
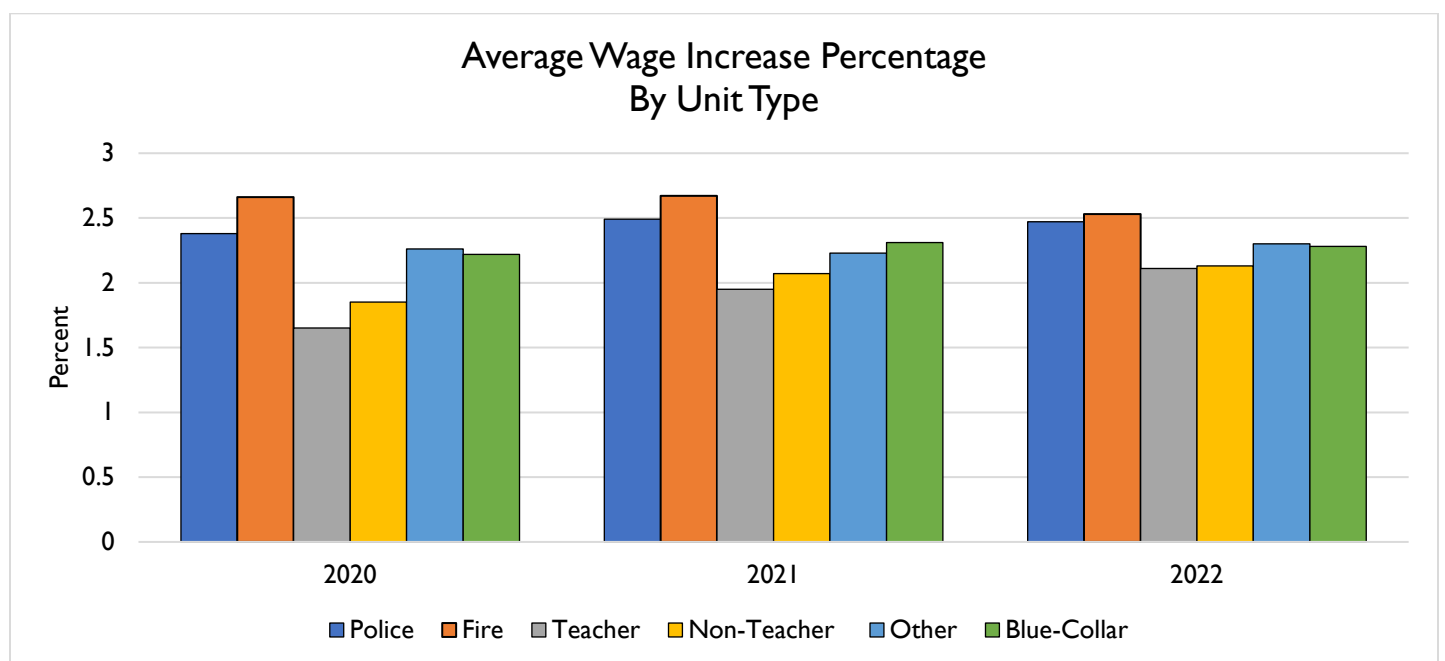


Chart 4 is a visual representation of the unit type section of the data found in Table 1. A detailed list of the bargaining unit types included in each group can be found on page 9.

Chart 4



AVERAGE WAGE INCREASE 10-YEAR TREND

Table 2 displays the average wage increase percentage negotiated in labor agreements for the past ten years. This percentage is calculated by taking all contracts that went into effect between January and December of that year and calculating an average of all the percent wage increases that took place during the duration of the contract. This includes year 1, 2, and 3 of the contracts if available. If a wage reopener, lump sum, or hourly increase is mentioned in the contract, those are excluded from this table.

Table 2

Average Negotiated Wage Increase Percentage (%) Over Entire Duration of Contract										
Comparison Group	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020
Statewide	0.73%	1.00%	1.47%	1.77%	2.02%	2.18%	2.20%	2.31%	2.31%	2.26%
Region										
(1) Akron/Canton	0.57%	0.72%	1.46%	1.76%	1.89%	2.00%	2.31%	2.24%	2.26%	2.28%
(2) Cincinnati	0.49%	1.14%	1.12%	1.68%	2.05%	2.41%	2.37%	2.63%	2.42%	2.47%
(3) Cleveland	0.68%	1.00%	1.49%	1.49%	1.99%	2.04%	2.15%	2.04%	2.07%	2.11%
(4) Columbus	1.12%	1.11%	1.64%	1.88%	2.19%	2.30%	2.19%	2.63%	2.60%	2.49%
(5) Dayton	0.68%	1.08%	1.41%	1.97%	2.24%	2.20%	2.33%	2.29%	2.55%	2.38%
(6) Southeast Ohio	1.38%	1.46%	1.90%	1.95%	2.07%	2.49%	2.03%	2.39%	2.18%	2.36%
(7) Toledo	0.74%	0.85%	1.39%	1.83%	1.87%	2.30%	2.32%	2.29%	2.25%	2.14%
(8) Warren/Youngstown	0.46%	0.85%	1.55%	1.70%	1.82%	1.61%	1.66%	2.15%	2.16%	1.91%
Jurisdiction										
City	0.93%	1.18%	1.61%	1.92%	2.06%	2.22%	2.16%	2.30%	2.44%	2.47%
County	0.72%	1.35%	1.81%	1.98%	2.12%	2.23%	2.26%	2.33%	2.43%	2.19%
Township	1.25%	1.01%	1.50%	1.88%	1.94%	2.24%	2.22%	2.65%	2.34%	2.56%
School District	0.35%	0.54%	1.17%	1.52%	1.93%	2.09%	2.20%	2.21%	2.17%	1.88%
Other									2.11%	2.43%
Unit Type										
Police (Safety/Security)	0.96%	1.20%	1.66%	2.03%	2.22%	2.36%	2.20%	2.50%	2.51%	2.44%
Fire	1.23%	1.21%	1.66%	1.86%	1.93%	2.34%	2.23%	2.32%	2.41%	2.62%
Teacher (BOE)	0.34%	0.60%	1.23%	1.56%	1.93%	2.04%	2.23%	2.30%	2.17%	1.83%
Non-Teaching (BOE)									2.16%	1.99%
Blue-Collar									2.26%	2.28%
Other	0.69%	1.01%	1.45%	1.69%	1.94%	2.03%	2.18%	2.17%	2.26%	2.26%
Contracts Reported	812	456	693	706	712	496	626	643	811	746
The Jurisdiction "Other" category was recently added; therefore, this information was omitted from previous reports. The Unit Type "Non-Teaching" and "Blue-Collar" categories were recently added. This data was included in the "Other" category in previous reports.										

The following four charts are visual representations of data found in Table 2.

Chart 5 displays the historical trend of the statewide average wage increase percentages found in Table 2 over the last ten years. These averages include year 1, 2, and 3 of each contract if available.

Chart 5

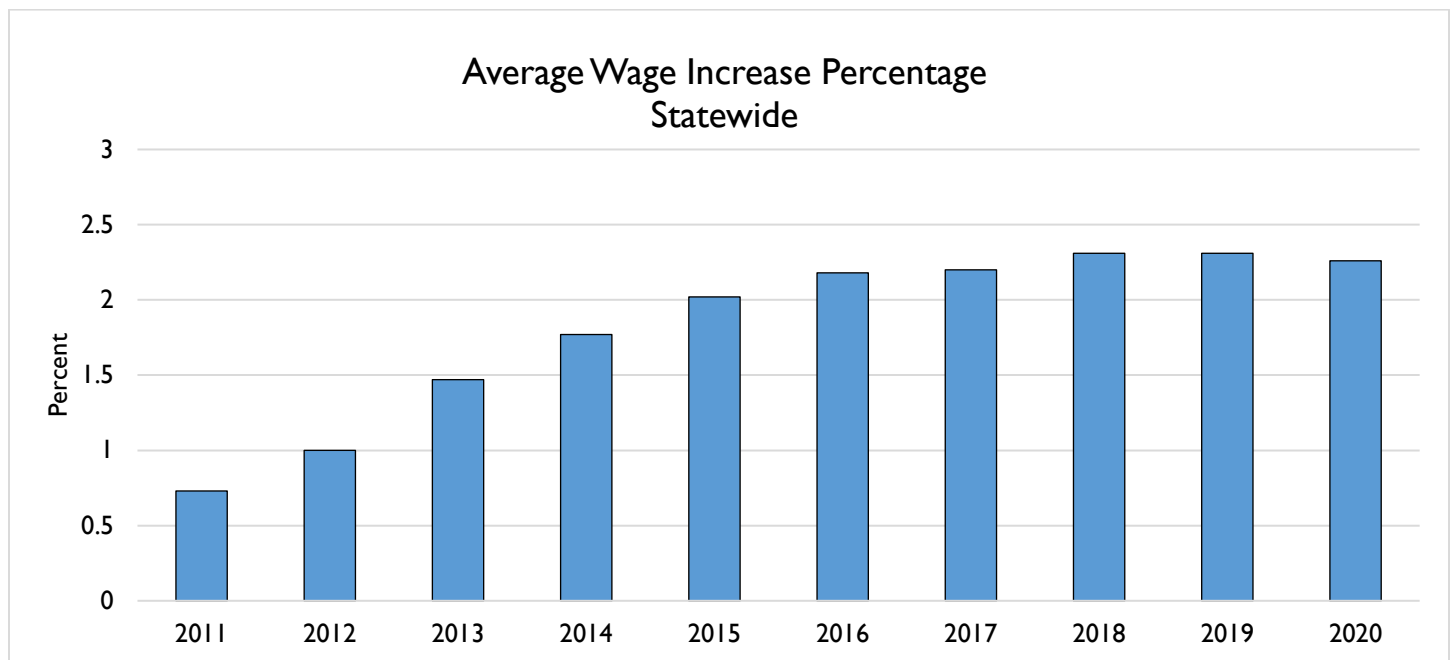


Chart 6 is a visual representation of the region section of the data found in Table 2. Each region consists of several nearby counties. A list of the counties included in each region can be found on page 9.

Chart 6

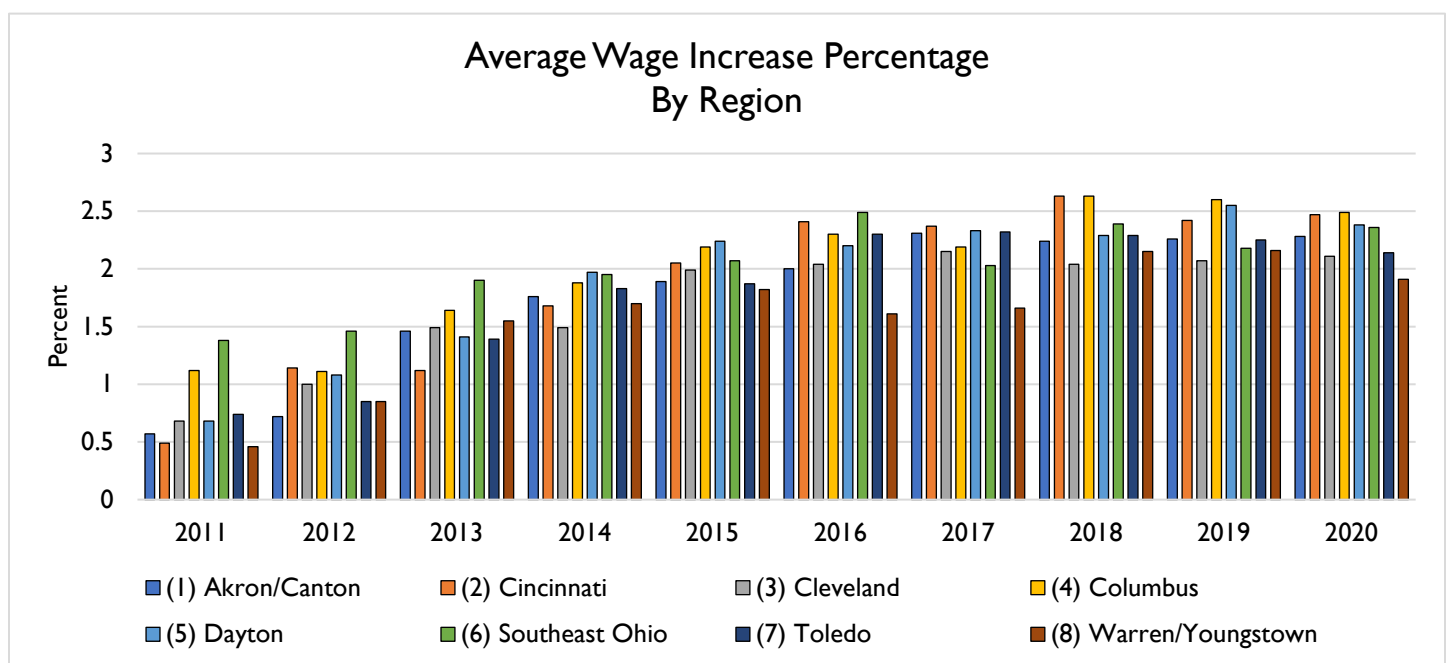


Chart 7 is a visual representation of the jurisdiction section of the data found in Table 2. A detailed list of the employer types included in each group can be found on page 9.

Chart 7

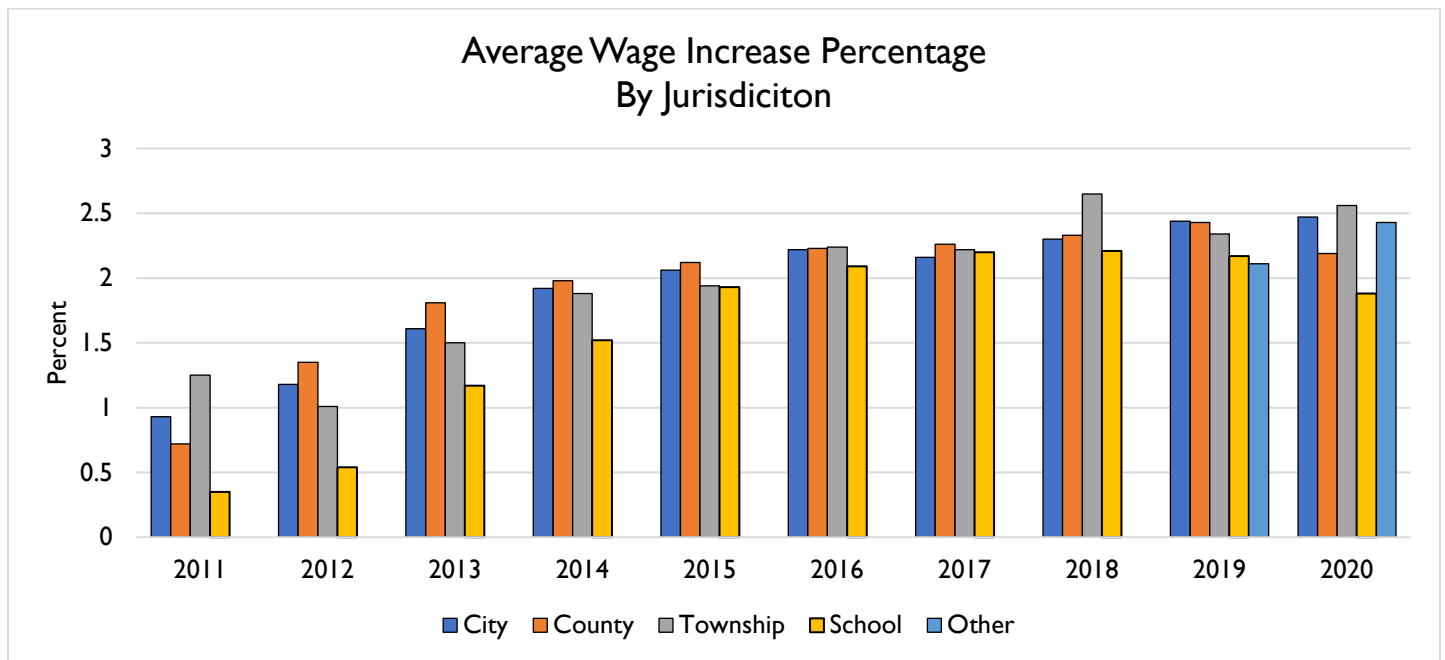
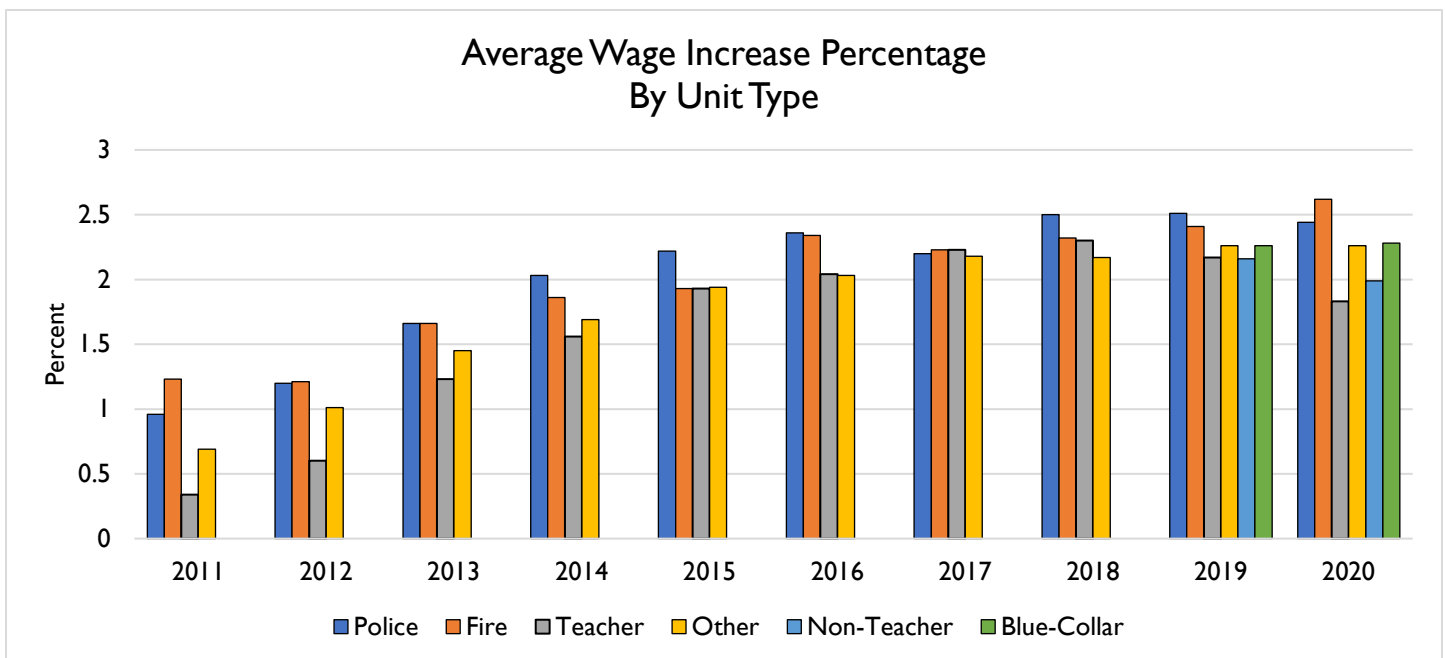


Chart 8 is a visual representation of the unit type section of the data found in Table 2. A detailed list of the bargaining unit types included in each group can be found on page 9.

Chart 8



LUMP SUM WAGE INCREASES

Table 3 displays the average lump sum negotiated in labor contracts that went into effect in calendar year 2020. A lump sum is a one-time dollar amount which is not added to the wage scale. In many cases, this is a signing bonus.

Table 3

Average One-Time Lump Sum (\$) By Contract Year												
Comparison Group	2020				2021				2022			
	Min	Max	Avg	#	Min	Max	Avg	#	Min	Max	Avg	#
Statewide	\$50	\$7,000	\$832	84	\$250	\$1,500	\$708	18	\$250	\$3,000	\$940	10
Jurisdiction												
City	\$250	\$7,000	\$906	17	\$250	\$1,250	\$600	5	\$500	\$500	\$500	1
County	\$150	\$2,176	\$851	34	\$500	\$1,000	\$700	3	\$500	\$600	\$550	2
Township	\$150	\$1,700	\$792	6	\$650	\$650	\$650	1	\$650	\$650	\$650	1
School District	\$50	\$1,500	\$826	23	\$250	\$1,500	\$831	8	\$250	\$3,000	\$1,192	6
Other	\$300	\$500	\$450	4	\$350	\$350	\$350	1				
Unit Type												
Police (Safety)	\$250	\$7,000	\$1,039	35	\$250	\$500	\$417	3				
Fire	\$150	\$500	\$325	2								
Teacher (BOE)	\$400	\$1,500	\$862	13	\$500	\$1,500	\$1,000	2	\$1,500	\$1,500	\$1,500	1
Non-Teacher (BOE)	\$50	\$1,500	\$742	12	\$225	\$1,500	\$750	7	\$250	\$3,000	\$1,042	6
Blue-Collar	\$500	\$500	\$500	6	\$500	\$500	\$500	2	\$500	\$500	\$500	2
Other	\$150	\$2,176	\$832	84	\$350	\$1,250	\$813	4	\$650	\$650	\$650	1
#: Number of Contracts (out of 828 total contracts filed) 64 out of 88 contracts (73%) have both Lump Sum and a percent or monetary increase during duration of the contract. Note: The \$7,000 lump sum was negotiated in a police officer contract in recognition of service during the pandemic.												

WAGE REOPENERS

There were 88 contracts that contained at least one wage reopener. There were 66 contracts that had a wage reopener in both year 2 and year 3. A wage reopener is an agreement between the employer and the union during contract negotiations stating that the parties agree to continue negotiations on the topic of wages in the future.

SERB REGIONS

Each region consists of several nearby counties. The county groupings, which were originally developed by SERB's Bureau of Mediation for the purpose of developing fact finder and conciliation panels, are as follows:

- 1 – Akron/Canton:** Ashland, Carroll, Coshocton, Harrison, Holmes, Medina, Portage, Stark, Summit, Tuscarawas, and Wayne.
- 2 – Cincinnati:** Adams, Brown, Butler, Clermont, Clinton, Hamilton, Highland, and Warren.
- 3 – Cleveland:** Ashtabula, Cuyahoga, Erie, Geauga, Huron, Lake, and Lorain.
- 4 – Columbus:** Crawford, Delaware, Fairfield, Fayette, Franklin, Knox, Licking, Madison, Marion, Morrow, Pickaway, Pike, Richland, Ross, Scioto, Union, and Wyandot.
- 5 – Dayton:** Auglaize, Champaign, Clark, Darke, Greene, Logan, Mercer, Miami, Montgomery, Preble, and Shelby.
- 6 – Southeast Ohio:** Athens, Belmont, Gallia, Guernsey, Hocking, Jackson, Lawrence, Meigs, Monroe, Morgan, Muskingum, Noble, Perry, Vinton, and Washington.
- 7 – Toledo:** Allen, Defiance, Fulton, Hancock, Hardin, Henry, Lucas, Ottawa, Paulding, Putnam, Sandusky, Seneca, Van Wert, Williams, and Wood.
- 8 – Warren/Youngstown:** Columbiana, Jefferson, Mahoning, and Trumbull.



JURISDICTION

Employers are grouped according to political subdivision.

City – This includes municipalities in Ohio with a population of 5,000 or more.

County – This includes all county level employers. Examples include: County Commissioners, Job and Family Services, Auditor, Recorder, Treasurer, Sheriff, Corrections, Mental Health, and Board of DD.

Township – This includes townships in Ohio with a population of 5,000 or more.

School District – This includes City, Local, and Exempted School Districts, Joint Vocational/Career and Technical Schools, and County Educational Service Centers.

Other – This includes all other jurisdictions. Examples include: State of Ohio departments and agencies, libraries, regional transit authorities, port authorities, metro housing authorities, fire districts, park districts, water and sewer districts, and colleges/universities.

UNIT TYPE

Below is a list of bargaining units that are included in each category.

Police (Safety/Security) – This includes bargaining units that contain uniformed police officers, sergeants, lieutenants, and captains across all jurisdictions, county sheriff deputies, corrections officers, security guards, and park rangers. It also includes safety dispatchers and E911 dispatchers.

Fire – This includes all fire suppression or fire prevention (firefighter) bargaining units.

Teacher (BOE) – This includes teaching and teaching mixed (teaching and non-teaching) bargaining units found in public school districts, educational service centers, and joint vocational schools.

Non-Teaching (BOE) – This includes non-teaching bargaining units found in public school districts, educational service centers, and joint vocational schools.

Blue-Collar – This includes bargaining units comprised of individuals who perform skilled or unskilled manual labor. These employees do not typically work in an office environment.

Other – This includes all other bargaining units not listed above. Examples include white-collar workers who work primarily in an office environment, nurses, and healthcare workers.

Additional Information

SERB maintains the Clearinghouse database which contains information on all public employers in the State of Ohio and their collective bargaining agreements dating back to 1984. The data extracted from these agreements is available upon request.

SERB CLEARINGHOUSE DATABASE

STANDARD REPORTS AVAILABLE

A standardized format has been developed for the following reports:

Benchmark Report:	Compares annualized entry- and top-level salaries for more than 300 job classifications. Note: Hourly rate is used for Board of Education non-teaching, libraries, and part-time classifications.
Benefit Report:	Provides an array of economic and non-economic benefit data.
Wage Increase Report:	Shows negotiated across-the-board wage adjustments.
Health Insurance Report:	Insurance data from the annual insurance survey submitted by public employers.
The following reports are available on the website:	
<u>Wage Settlement Report:</u>	Published March of each year, provides negotiated across-the-board wage adjustments.
<u>Annual Healthcare Report:</u>	Published August 1st of each year, provides public sector insurance statistics.

Please allow two weeks for your research request to be processed.

Learn more:

[Clearinghouse Guidebook](#)

Submit a Research Request:

[Clearinghouse Research Request Form](#)